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# Romanian IT Market Study Evolution and Perspectives

— Cluj-Napoca, 2026 —



## Research team:

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### **The IT industry from a macroeconomic perspective**

Global IT industry | Romania's IT competitiveness | Economic analysis of the Romanian ICT industry

### **IT companies in Romania**

Performance of IT companies | Regional distribution | Major IT hubs

### **A diagnosis of operations in IT companies in Romania**

Remote work | Internationalization | AI solutions | Innovation |  
Collaborative ecosystems | Diversity & sustainability | Future outlook

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# Global IT industry

The **global IT industry** undergoes a fundamental transformation led by the adoption of AI that is entering the enterprise-wide implementation phase of **specialized AI solutions** for intelligent automation, such as agentic AI or small language modelling. Consequently, **job profiles are changing**, with data management and AI-related jobs on the rise.

## GLOBAL TRENDS TO LOOK OUT FOR IN THE ICT INDUSTRY

### TECHNOLOGY SHIFTS

#### Enterprise AI adoption

- Generative AI moves from experimentation to **enterprise-wide deployment**
- Rise of specialized AI, small language models, multimodal and agentic AI

#### Intelligent automation of business processes

- AI embedded in enterprise systems enables **predictive, adaptive workflows**
- Automation accelerates software development, operations and maintenance

### DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

#### Advanced computing and connectivity

- **Cloud and edge computing** distribute workloads and optimize infrastructure
- **5G/6G, Wi-Fi 6/7** and **low-orbit satellites** expand connectivity
- These infrastructures support IoT, AI applications and autonomous systems

#### Next-generation technologies

- **Quantum computing** promises exponentially faster calculations
- Requires development of **post-quantum cybersecurity**

### WORKFORCE TRANSFORMATION

#### AI-driven demand for new skills and emergence of new roles

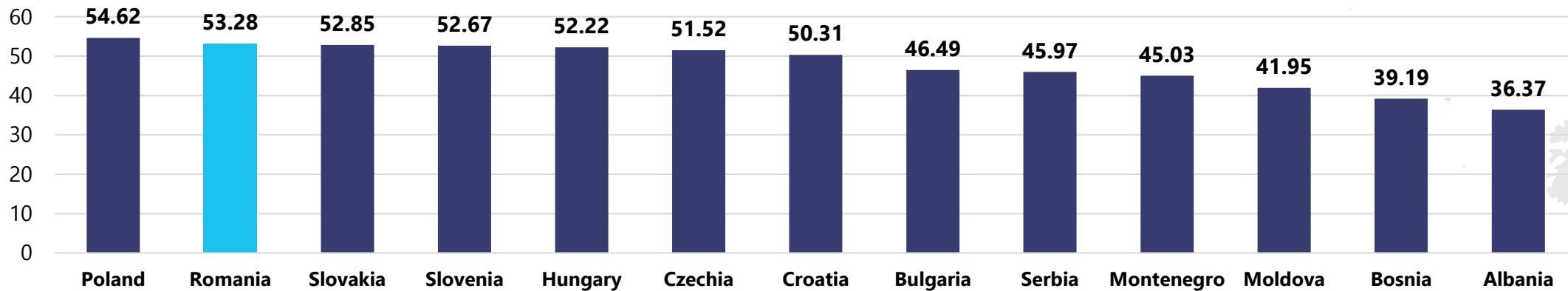
#### Top jobs trending in 2025 in IT:

- Data analyst and scientist
- AI and machine learning specialist
- Big Data specialist
- Digital marketing and strategy specialist
- Process automation specialist

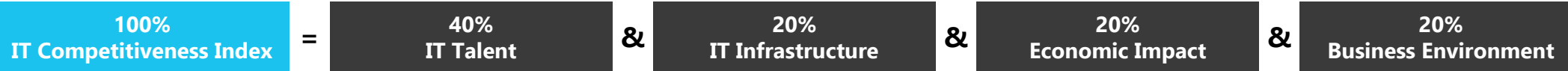
# Romania's IT competitiveness

In the transforming global IT landscape, **Romania** continues to offer a **competitive environment** for IT businesses, standing out in the Central and Southern European region with its robust **IT infrastructure** and employees capable of performing **high value-added activities**.

IT Competitiveness Index in Central and Southern Europe, 2024 (score)



IT Competitiveness Index: Maximum Global Utility Method (based on 49 criteria)



## IT Infrastructure

Rank: **1<sup>st</sup> place**

Romania's strength lies in its robust **data center infrastructure**, boasting **48 data centers** and ranking **1<sup>st</sup>** in this category in Central and Southern Europe.\*

## Economic Impact

Rank: **3<sup>rd</sup> place**

Romania's strength relies on the countries' **rising exports** and excellent performance in **output** and **value added** per employee, as well as its cost competitiveness.

**Source:** Emerging Europe

\*Even if having a good basis, IT infrastructure needs further development, such as improving 5G coverage (Eurostat)

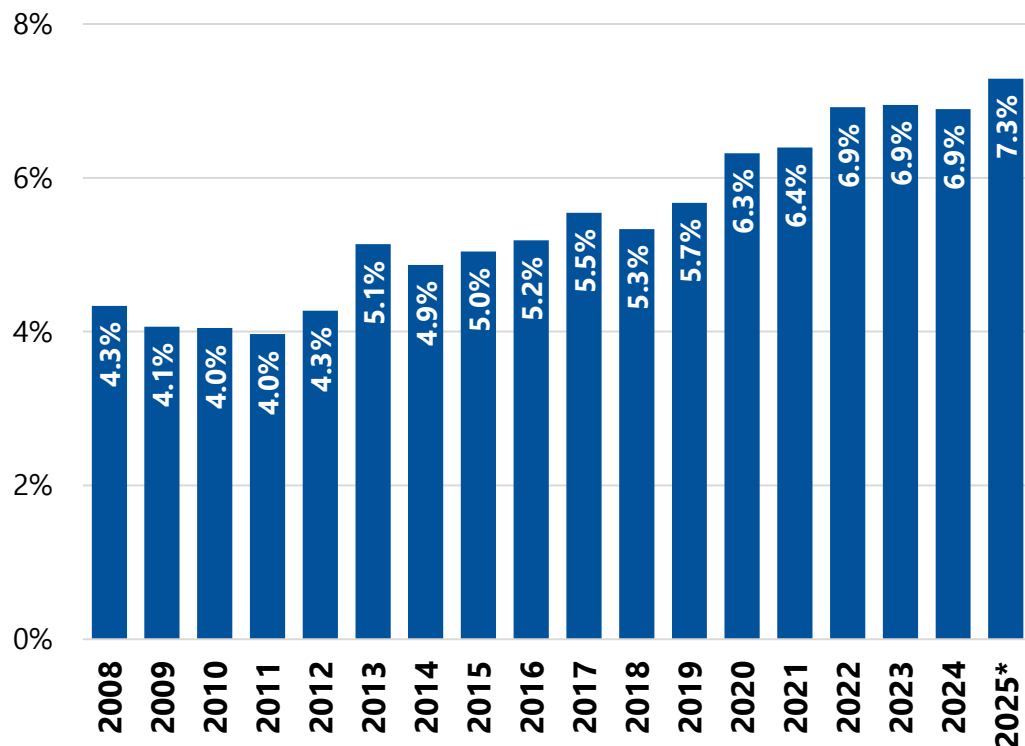
**\*Disclaimer:** The designations employed and the presentation of material in the maps do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of the EBRD, the EU, BBU, Transilvania IT Cluster or any other parties involved in the study concerning the legal or constitutional status of any country, territory or sea area, or concerning the delimitation of frontiers.



# ICT value added as % of GDP and employment statistics

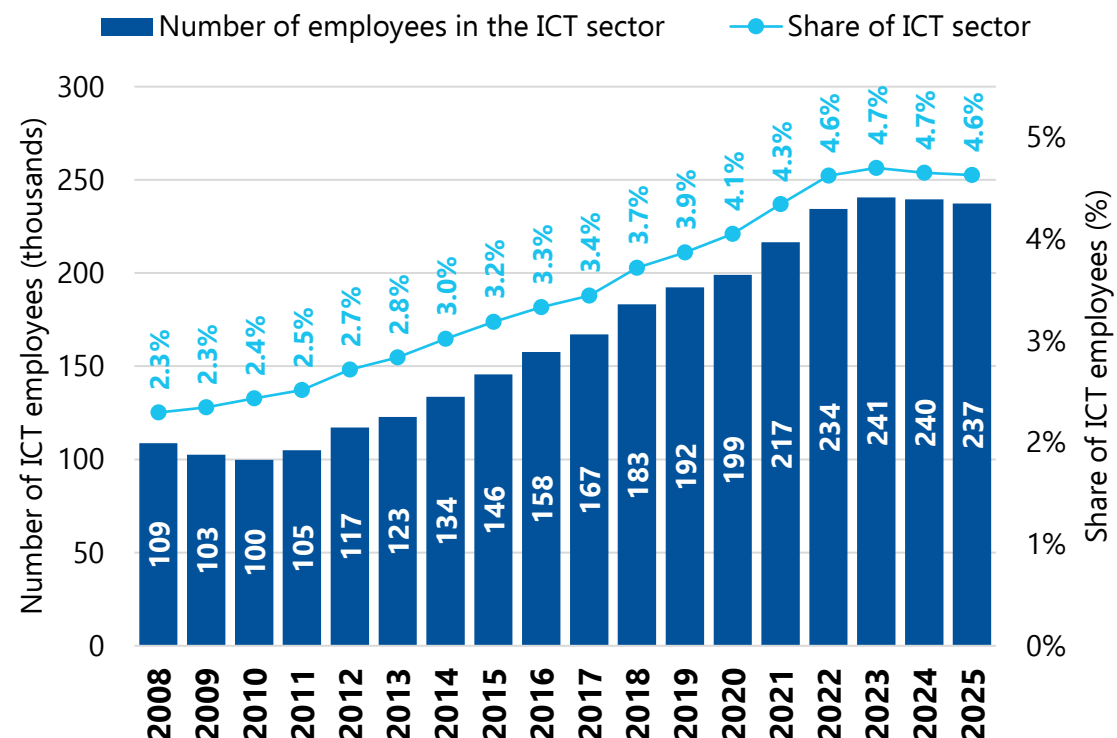
The ICT industry plays an important role in the evolution of the Romanian economy reaching by 2025 over **7% of GDP** and almost **5% of employment**. While the share of the ICT sector in GDP has shown a growing trend over the last 15 years, the **growth of employee numbers has come to a halt**, decreasing slightly in the past two years.

## Yearly ICT value added as % of GDP, 2008-2025



\*2025 Q1-Q3

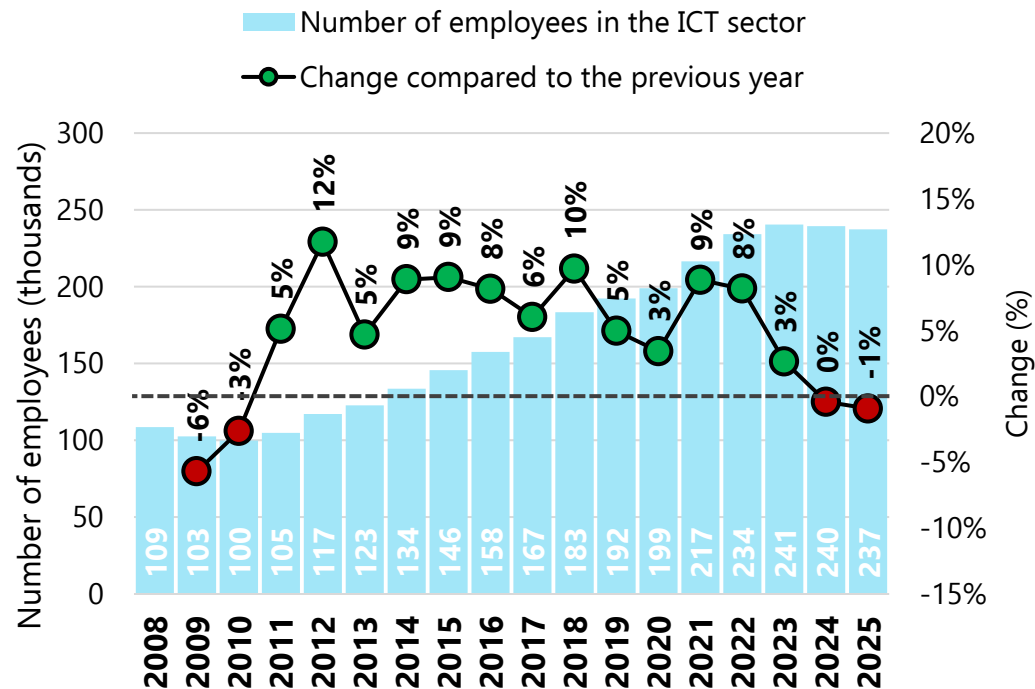
## Employee number in the ICT sector, 2008-2025



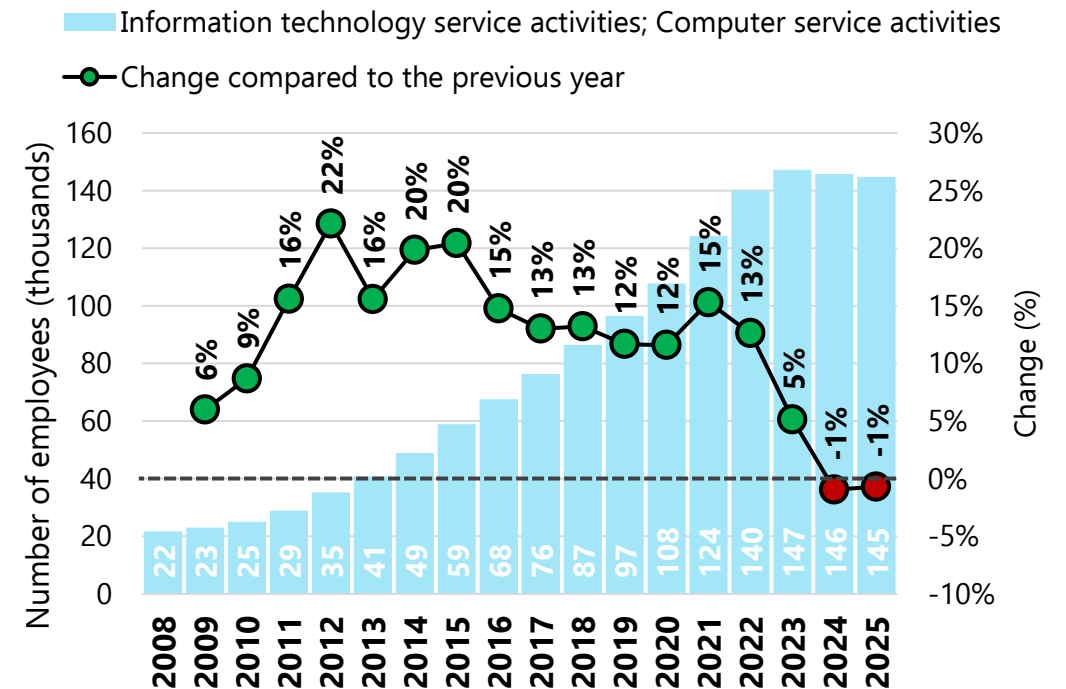
# Negative employment growth rate in recent years

The Romanian ICT sector employs over 235,000 people, out of which over **145,000 work in the IT industry**. While both indicators have shown a growing trend in recent years, the annual **growth rate** has dropped significantly and **turned negative in 2024 and 2025**.

## Number of employees in the ICT sector, 2008-2025



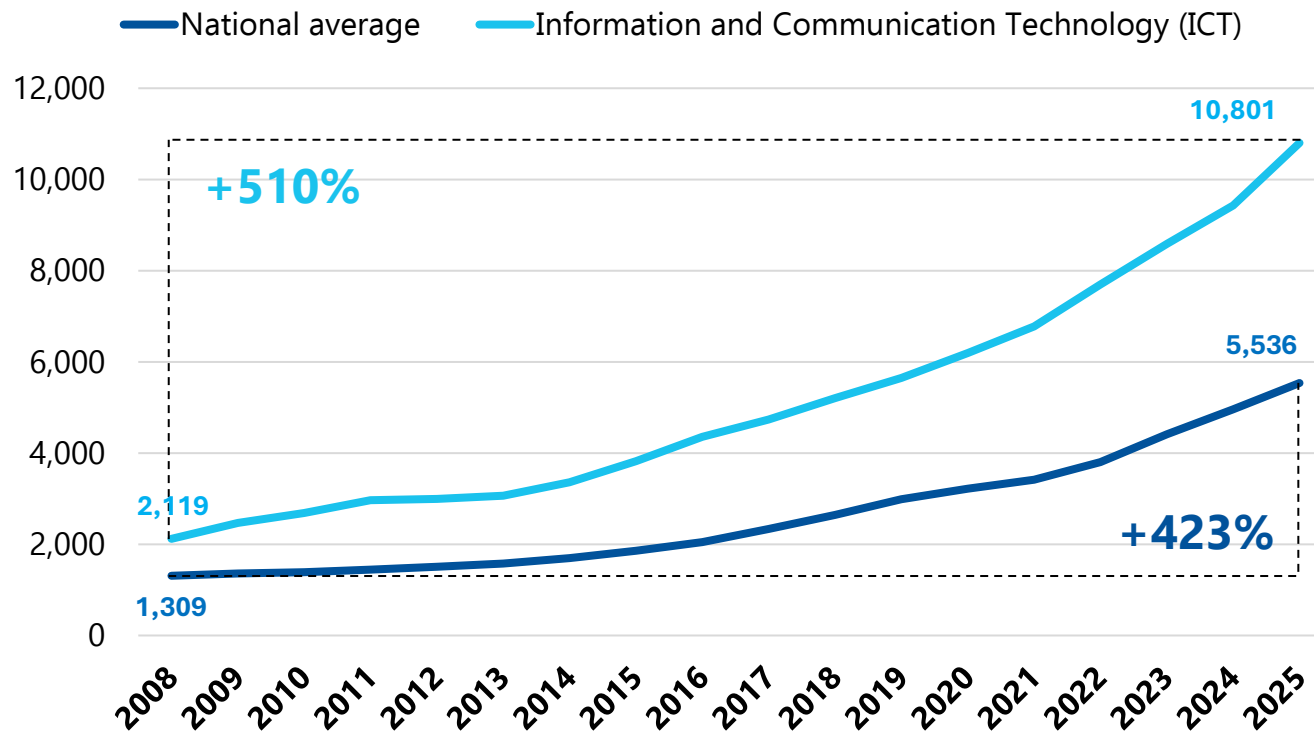
## Number of employees in the IT sector, 2008-2025



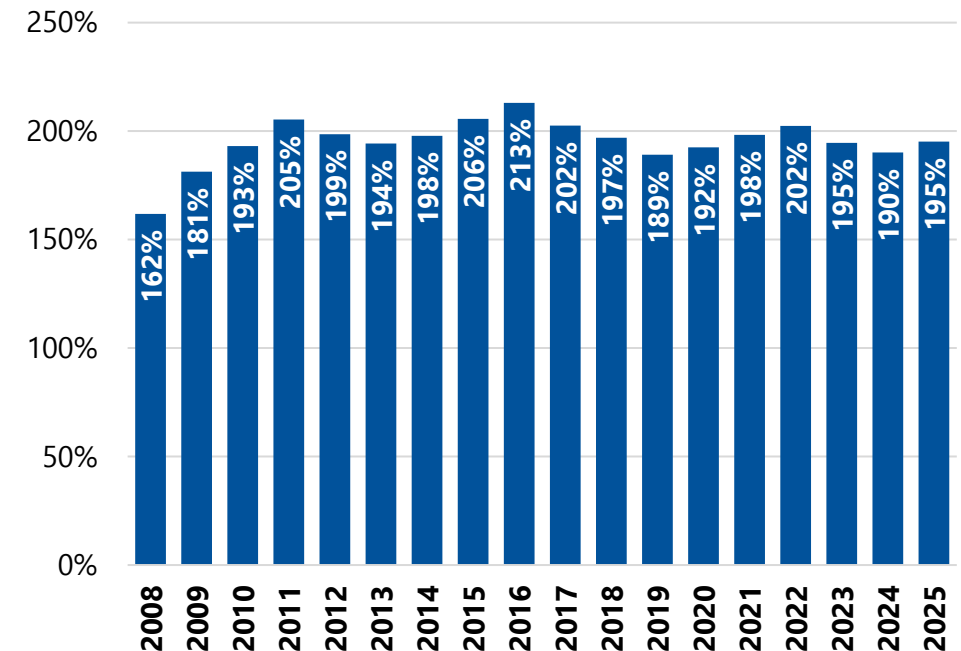
# Average monthly net salaries in the ICT industry

Average monthly net salaries in the ICT sector have **grown significantly faster** than the national average over the past 15 years. **By 2025, they exceeded 2,000 EUR**, making ICT the best-paid sector in the Romanian economy, with wages consistently around **twice the national average salary**.

Evolution of average monthly net salaries, 2008-2025 (RON)



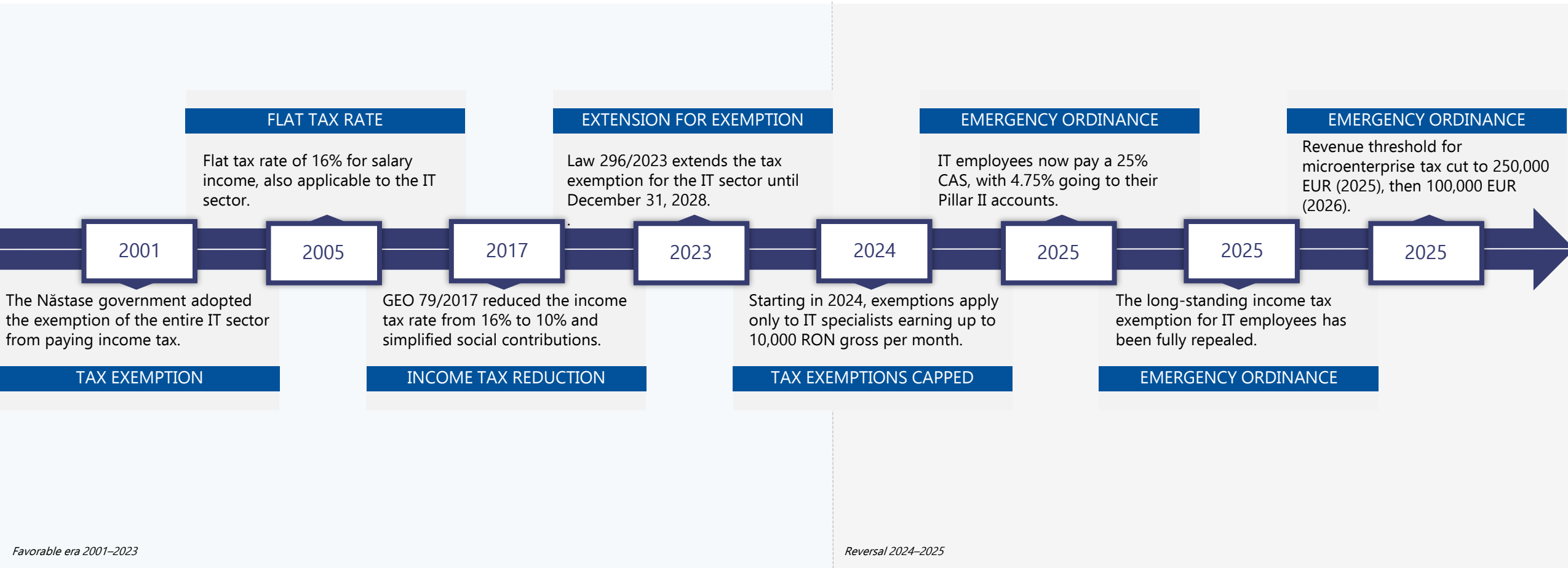
Average monthly net salaries in ICT sector vs national average monthly salary, 2008-2025 (%)





# Key fiscal measures in the Romanian ITC industry

**Generous tax incentives** have supported the IT sector's growth for more than **two decades**. Recent reforms have gradually phased out these advantages, **fully repealing IT income-tax exemptions in 2025**. The decrease of microenterprise revenue threshold (to 250,000 EUR in 2025, 100,000 EUR in 2026) also means that more IT firms will pay standard corporate taxes.



# Expected performance of ICT sub-sectors in Romania

Despite global transformations and local challenges, **the Romanian ICT sector is projected to grow** with a collective average of **4.7% per year** (CAGR, 2025-2030) due to a dynamically developing **startup ecosystem**, the **diversification of services**, the application of **emerging technologies** and expected continuation of government spending on digitalization based on **EU funds**.

## KEY INDUSTRY DRIVERS

- 1

**Startup Ecosystem**  
1,500+ startups, 100+ incubators & accelerators, active VC/PE network
- 2

**Service Diversification**  
Web dev, mobile, e-commerce, UI design, IT strategy consulting
- 3

**Emerging Technologies**  
AI, IoT & cybersecurity focus; IoT market → 2.6B EUR by 2026
- 4

**Government Initiatives**  
NRRP: public digitalization, digital skills, secure infrastructure

## ICT INDUSTRY SEGMENTATION

|                                                                                   |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>IT Services</b><br>IT Outsourcing · BPO · IT Consulting · Other IT             | NACE: 622; 629 |
| <b>Software</b><br>Enterprise · App Dev · System Infra · Productivity             | NACE: 582; 621 |
| <b>Communication Services</b><br>Mobile · Fixed Communications                    | NACE: 611-619  |
| <b>Consumer Electronics</b><br>Telephony · TV/Radio · Computing · Drones · Gaming | NACE: 261-264  |
| <b>Data Centers</b><br>Network Infrastructure · Servers · Storage                 | NACE: 631-639  |

TOTAL MARKET SIZE  
(2025)

11.5B EUR

MARKET CAGR  
(2025 - 2030)

+4.7%

## MARKET SIZE & REVENUE GROWTH BY SEGMENT

| IT Services                                                                                                                                                  | Software                                                                                                                                                                               | Communication Services                                                                                                          | Consumer Electronics                                                                                                                                            | Data Centers                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2026 Forecasted Revenue (RON)</b><br><b>6.86 billion</b>                                                                                                  | <b>2026 Forecasted Revenue (RON)</b><br><b>2.05 billion</b>                                                                                                                            | <b>2026 Forecasted Revenue (RON)</b><br><b>35.1 billion</b>                                                                     | <b>2026 Forecasted Revenue (RON)</b><br><b>15.1 billion</b>                                                                                                     | <b>2026 Forecasted Revenue (RON)</b><br><b>1.59 billion</b>                                                                                                               |
| <b>+4.94% CAGR (2025-2030)</b>                                                                                                                               | <b>+5.22% CAGR (2025-2030)</b>                                                                                                                                                         | <b>+4.49% CAGR (2025-2030)</b>                                                                                                  | <b>+1.99% CAGR (2025-2030)</b>                                                                                                                                  | <b>+7.04% CAGR (2025-2030)</b>                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Sub-segment breakdown (2026):</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>IT Outsourcing: 2.6B RON</li><li>BPO: 2B RON</li><li>Other IT: 1.8B RON</li></ul> | <b>Sub-segment breakdown (2026):</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Enterprise SW: 856M RON</li><li>App Development: 539M RON</li><li>System Infrastructure: 430M RON</li></ul> | <b>Sub-segment breakdown (2026):</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Mobile: 21.4B RON</li><li>Fixed: 13.7B RON</li></ul> | <b>Sub-segment breakdown (2026):</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Telephony: 6.4B RON</li><li>TV/Radio: 4.8B RON</li><li>Computing: 3.6B RON</li></ul> | <b>Sub-segment breakdown (2026):</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Network Infrastructure: 798M RON</li><li>Servers: 589M RON</li><li>Storage: 201M RON</li></ul> |

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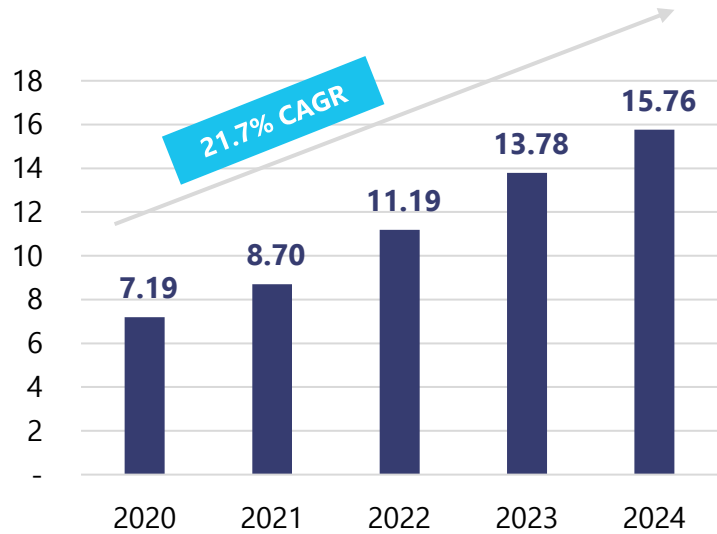
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# Sustained growth and productivity gains

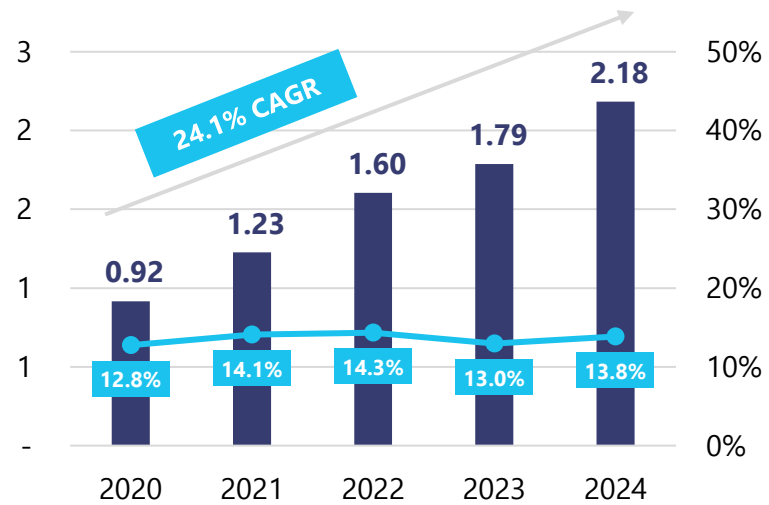
IT companies in Romania have shown spectacular growth in the last 5 years, **increasing sales by over 20% yearly** coupled with stable average **net profit margins (13-14%)** and a significant **growth in employee productivity**.

Total turnover of Romanian IT companies, 2020-2024 (billion EUR)



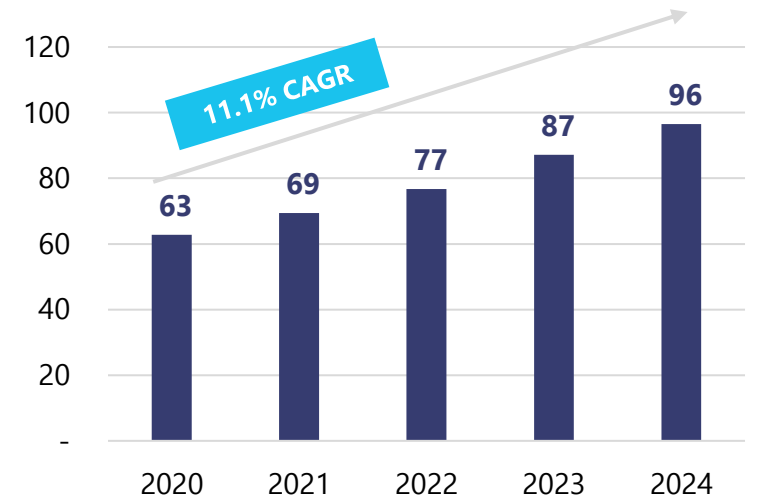
Total turnovers have registered a stable and steady growth between 2020-2024.

Total net profit and profit margin of Romanian IT companies, 2020-2024 (billion EUR, %)



The growth rate of the net profits also experienced a slight slowdown in 2023, but bounced back in 2024.

Turnover per employee in Romanian IT companies, 2020-2024 (thousand EUR)



Romanian IT companies have significantly improved their efficiency through increasing their turnover per employee.

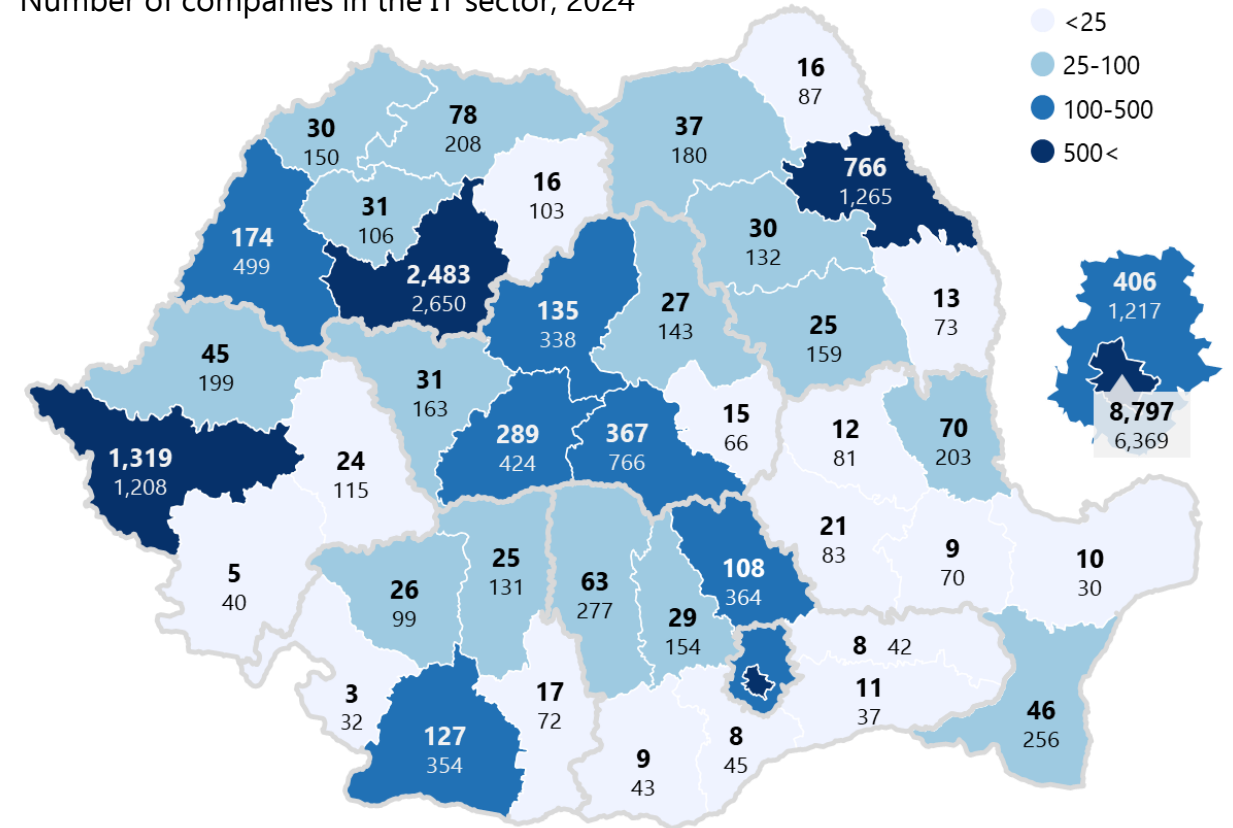
**Source:** Analysis based on the ListaFirme database  
**Note:** The research includes all 19,033 Romanian IT companies with latest yearly turnover exceeding 50,000 EUR

# Regional concentration of Romania's IT companies

**Bucharest-Ilfov is the leading location** contributing with over 50% of the sales of the total sector, while the **North-West region** occupies a **strong second place** with a slightly less than 20% contribution. On a county level, the **capital** is followed by **Cluj, Timiș and Iași**, representing the most significant IT hubs in Romania with prominent university centers and high levels of foreign investment. Together with Ilfov, these **5 counties account for 87% of the total sales** of the Romanian IT industry.

## County-level turnover of IT companies, 2024 (m EUR)

Number of companies in the IT sector, 2024



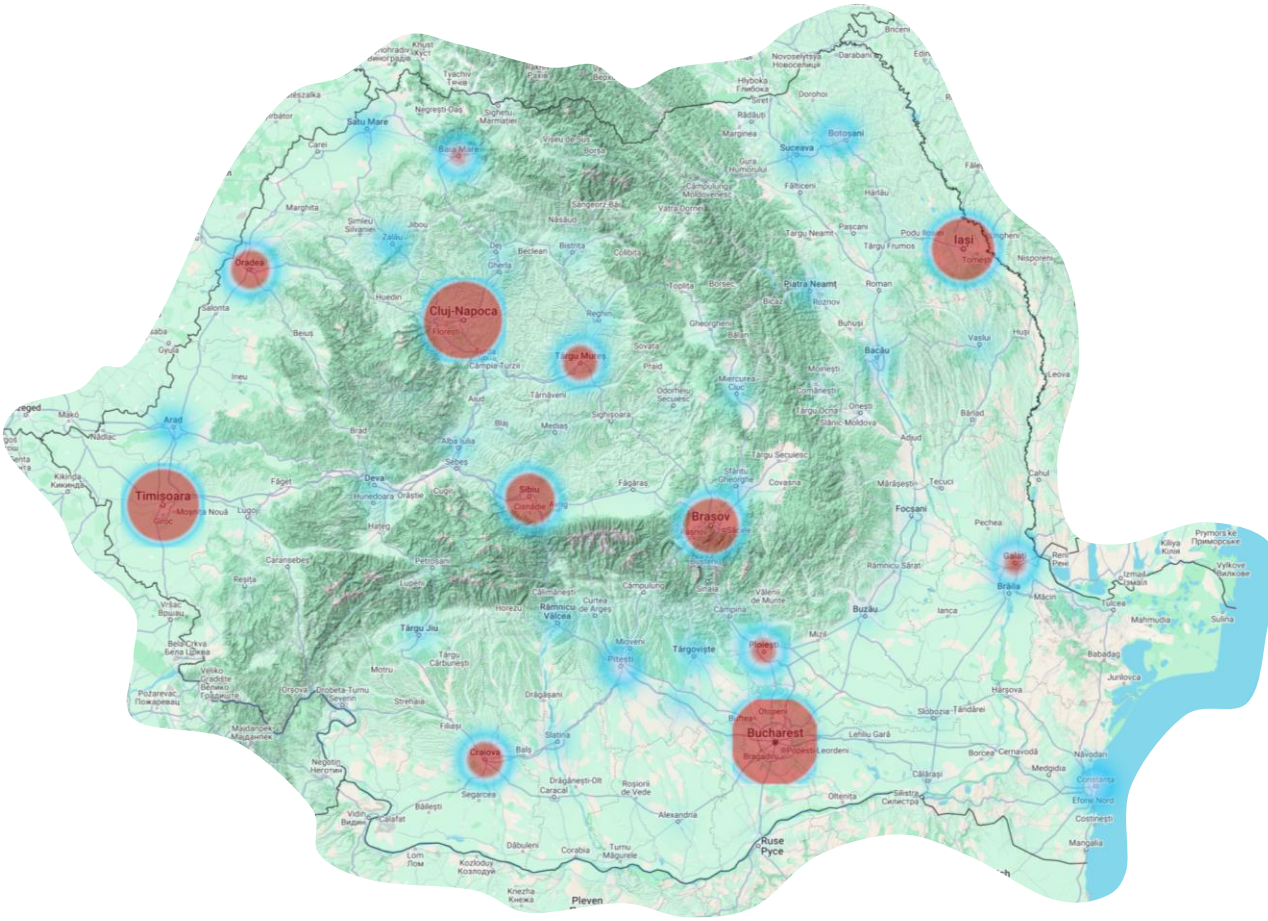
**Source:** Analysis based on the ListaFirme database

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# Leading cities in the Romanian IT industry

In terms of cities, the **top 5 IT hubs** are **Bucharest, Cluj-Napoca, Timișoara, Iași** and **Brașov**. These 5 cities account for **85% of total sales**, **84% of employees** and 56% of the total number of companies in the Romanian IT sector.



| City                                     | Turnover   | Net Profit | Number of companies | Employees  | Average year of establishment |
|------------------------------------------|------------|------------|---------------------|------------|-------------------------------|
| based on 2024 data                       | m EUR      | m EUR      | pcs                 | thousands  | Year                          |
| 1. <b>Bucharest</b>                      | 8,797      | 937        | 6,369               | 80.1       | 2017                          |
| 2. <b>Cluj-Napoca</b>                    | 2,351      | 289        | 2,082               | 28.6       | 2018                          |
| 3. <b>Timișoara</b>                      | 1,236      | 75         | 803                 | 13.1       | 2018                          |
| 4. <b>Iași</b>                           | 693        | 95         | 863                 | 11.0       | 2018                          |
| 5. <b>Brașov</b>                         | 331        | 54         | 558                 | 3.9        | 2017                          |
| <b>% of the total Romanian IT sector</b> | <b>85%</b> | <b>66%</b> | <b>56%</b>          | <b>84%</b> | -                             |

**Source:** Analysis based on the ListaFirme database

**Note:** The research includes all 19,033 Romanian IT companies with latest yearly turnover exceeding 50,000 EUR

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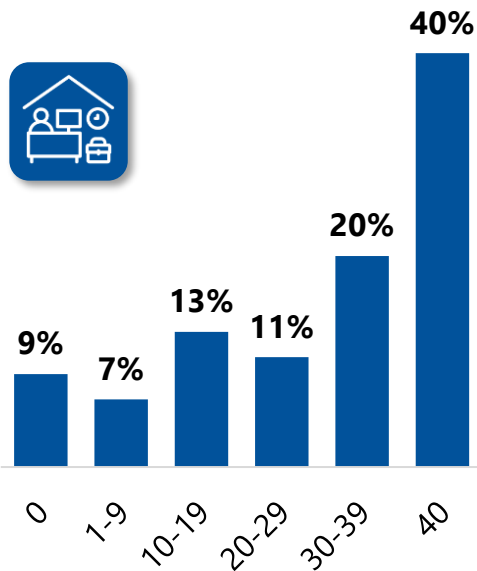
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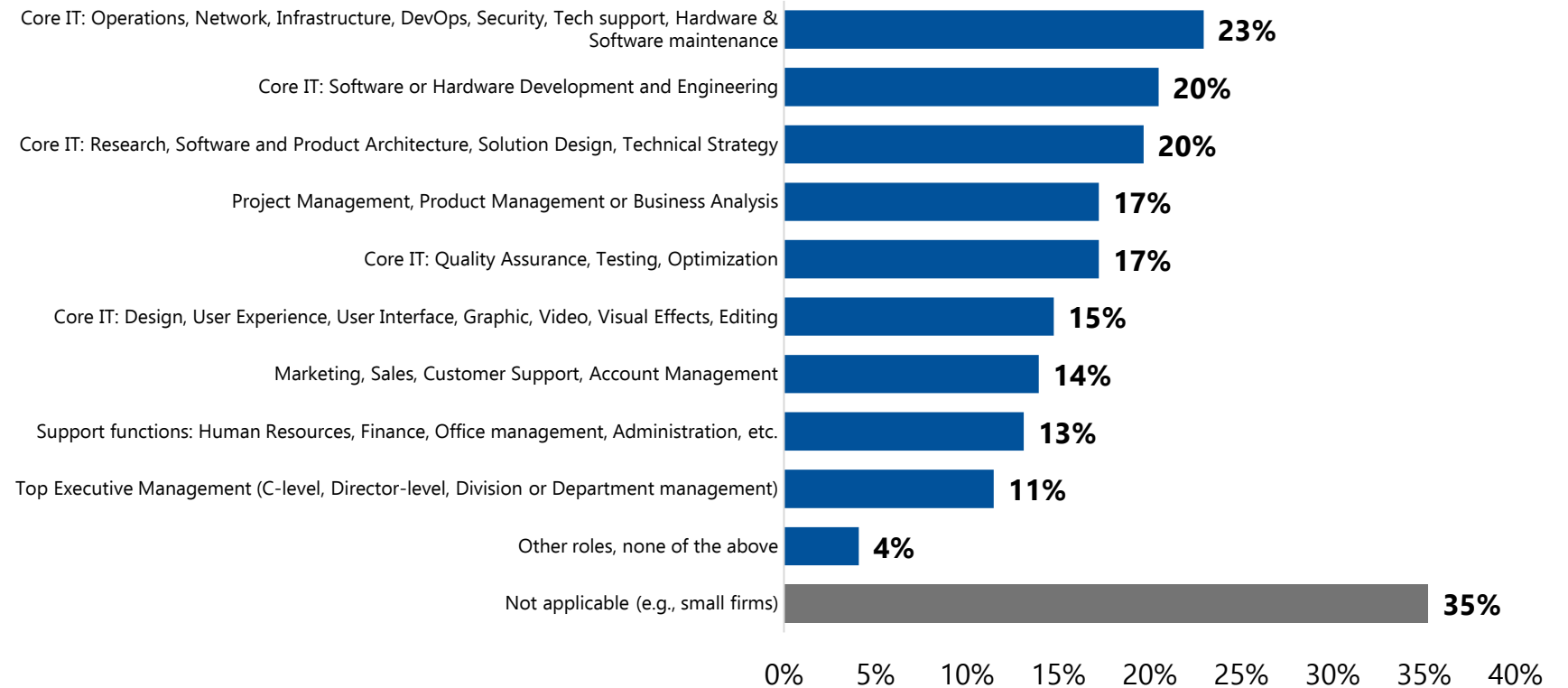
# Remote work

Remote work remains substantial across IT companies, especially in **core IT-related activities** as opposed to business functions. **40% of surveyed IT companies** in Romania are still using **full remote work**.

Work hours carried out remotely (from home office) on average per employee on a typical 40-hour working week



## Departments that work remotely the most (%)



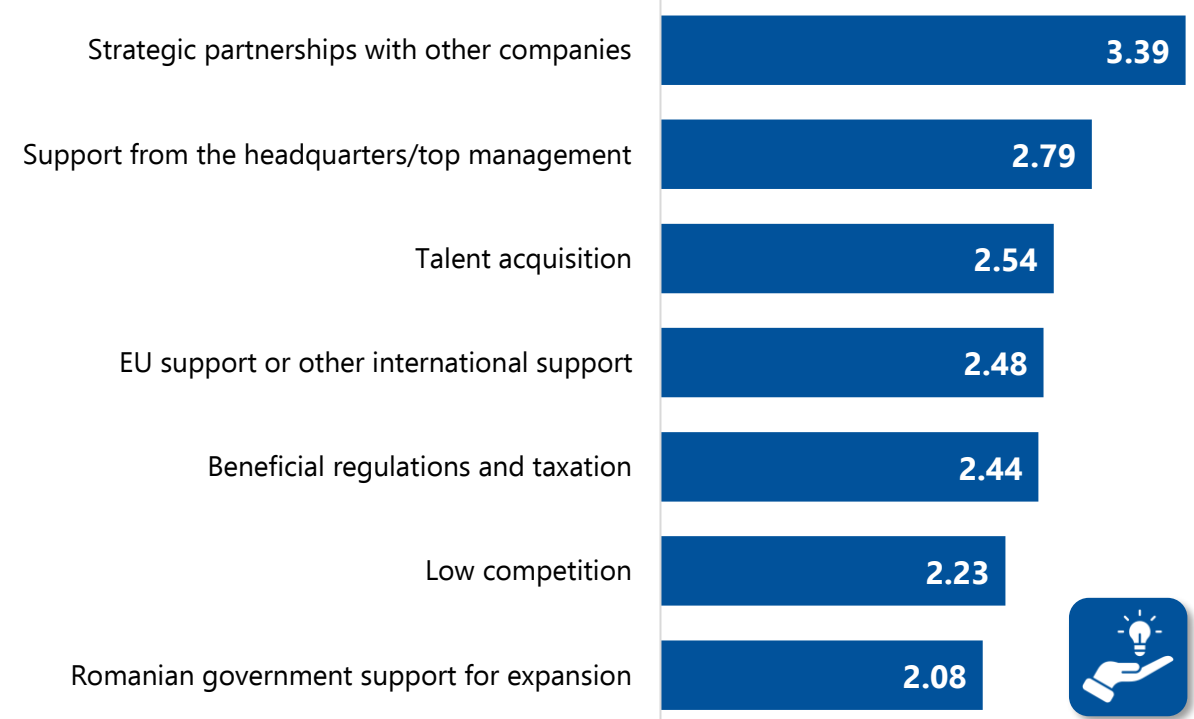
# Internationalization

Internationalization is perceived as a challenging task mainly due to **market entry barriers** and **high competition in Europe and the U.S.** coupled with the lack of international visibility, financial constraints and lack of information. **Strategic partnerships with foreign companies** are, on the other hand, regarded as the best **opportunity for internationalization**.

## Perceived **barriers** in IT company internationalization (1-5 Likert scale)



## Perceived **opportunities** in IT company internationalization (1-5 Likert scale)



# AI solutions

Almost **65% of employees** in IT companies **use AI solutions daily** with only **6% of jobs being replaced by AI** in 2025, percentage expected to rise to 12% by 2028. AI is mainly used for knowledge management, IT product enhancement and automation of employee tasks. **Immature AI technologies** and **overhyped AI solutions** represent the main barriers of adoption.



64.4%

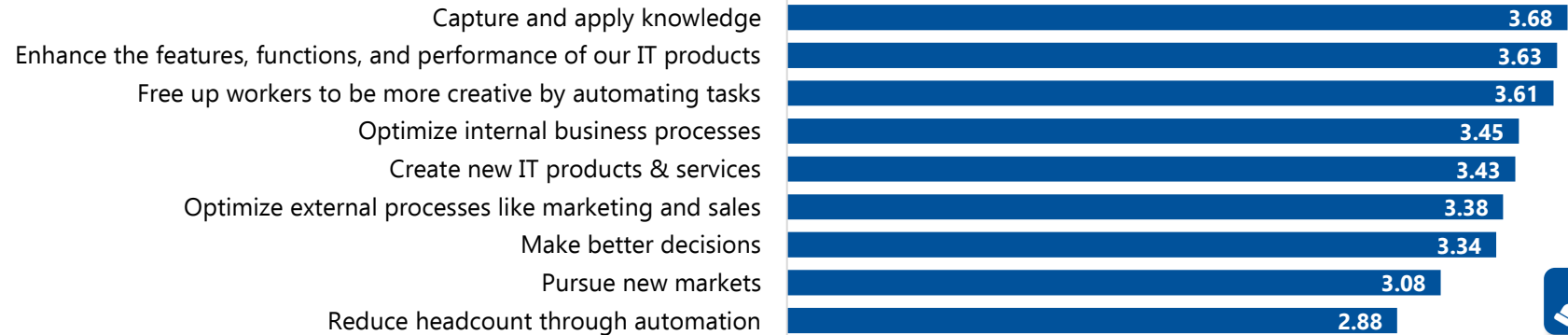
Use company-provided  
AI solutions



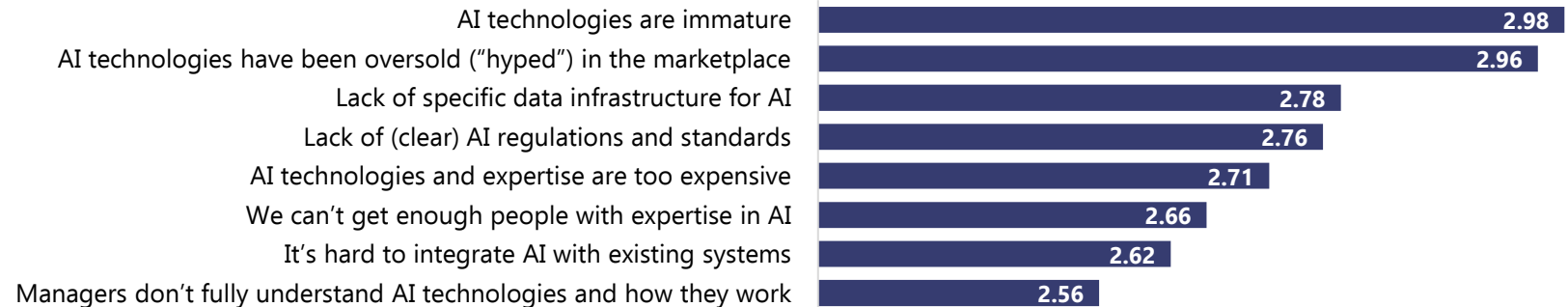
12.0%

IT jobs replaced by AI  
solutions in the  
following 3 years

## Perceived **usefulness** of AI solutions across business domains (1-5 Likert scale)



## Perceived **barriers** to implementing AI solutions (1-5 Likert scale)

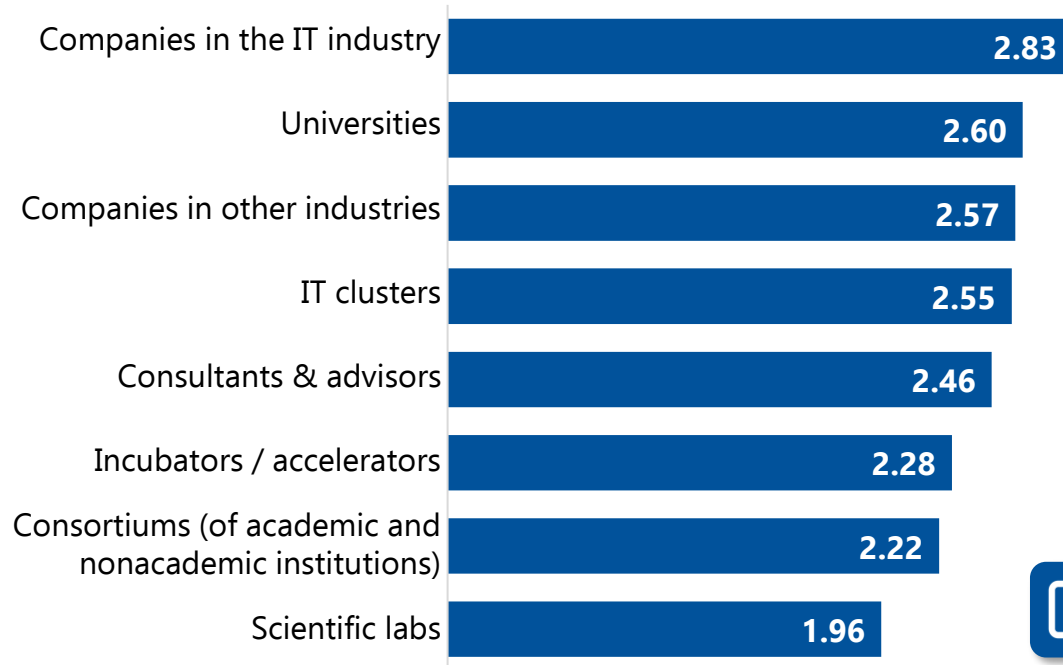




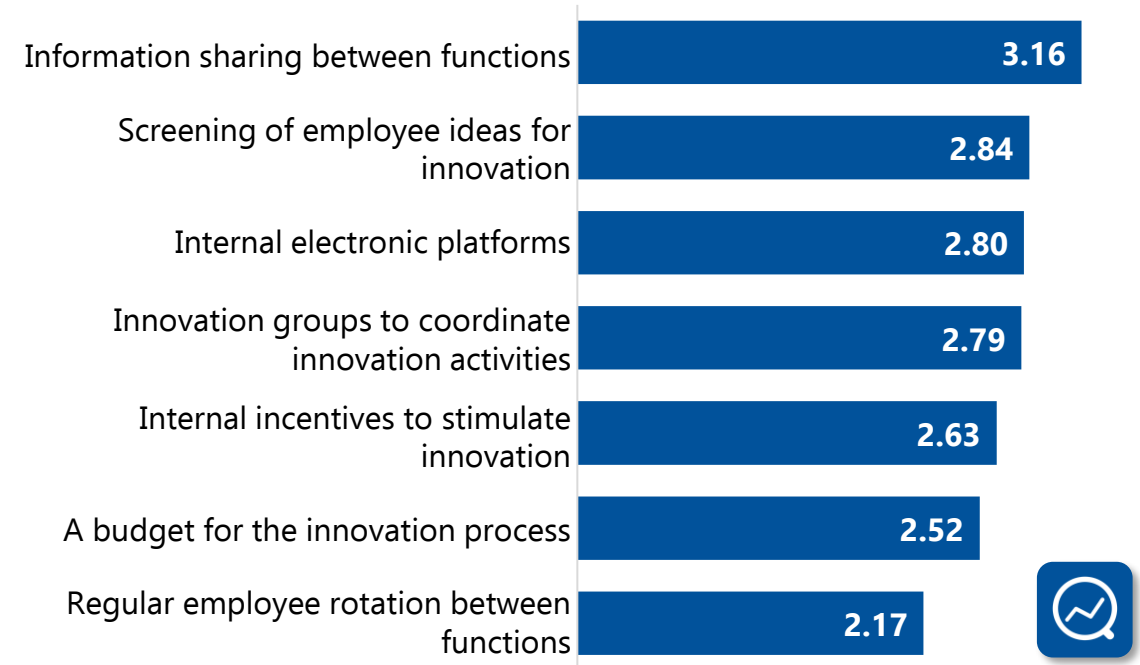
# Innovation

Innovation in IT companies, e.g., the development of AI solutions, is **generally done internally**. **External collaboration is low** and is mostly done with other companies. **Information sharing between functions** and through **internal platforms**, screening **employee ideas for innovation**, and creating **dedicated innovation groups** are the most frequent internal activities.

## Extent of cooperation with external entities in innovative projects (1-5 Likert scale)



## Extent of using internal activities to support innovative projects (1-5 Likert scale)



# Sources of financing for innovation

Similar to the infrequent collaboration with the external innovation ecosystem, the level of using **external grants for innovation funding is also low**. Internal financing is dominant, while the application for external financing is **bureaucratic** and **slow**. External resource sharing is mostly done with client companies only.



## DOMINANCE OF INTERNAL FINANCING

- Innovation is primarily funded through **internal cash flow** and **reinvested profits**
- Companies maintain **cautious financing strategies**, integrating innovation spending into operational budgets
- Firms express **a need for more diversified financing sources**, including venture capital and angel investment



## INNOVATION THROUGH COLLABORATION

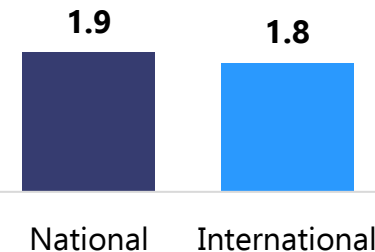
- Many companies **co-develop solutions with clients**, prioritizing shared technological learning
- **Innovation** typically arises from **applied projects rather than formal R&D programs**



## EXISTING SOURCES OF EXTERNAL FINANCING

- **Non-reimbursable local and EU grants** represent the most frequently used external funding source
- **Venture capital** and **angel investment** opportunities exist but remain limited in Romania compared to regional peers

Extent of using national and international funds\* to support innovative projects in the past 3 years (1-5 Likert scale)



\*Funds: grant opportunities



## STRUCTURAL AND CULTURAL BARRIERS

- **Administrative complexity** and **bureaucratic procedures** limit access to external financing
- **Eligibility rules** and **regulatory requirements** further constrain funding opportunities
- **Risk aversion** among entrepreneurs reduces the willingness to pursue external capital



## HIGHLIGHT

Both national and international funding programs play a role in supporting innovation, however, their usage remains low, indicating that IT companies continue to rely primarily on internal financing mechanisms.

# Collaborative ecosystems

Membership in associations and clusters is mostly used for **networking purposes** and for gaining more opportunities for **(inter)national exposure**. The currently **immature but dynamically developing start-up ecosystem** with incubators and accelerator programs offers good potential for the future.



## COLLABORATION AND NETWORKING

- Membership in industry associations primarily supports **networking opportunities** and **international exposure** (e.g., fairs, joint stands)
- Startups and multinational companies increasingly **collaborate** through **incubator** and **accelerator programs**
- In many cases, **association membership** is expected in the local market, contributing mainly to **visibility**



## STRENGTHENING THE "VOICE" OF THE INDUSTRY

- There is a recognized **need for stronger collective representation of the IT industry**
- **Clusters and industry associations could act as key advocates**, but the ecosystem remains fragmented
- The IT sector is widely viewed as a **strategic driver of Romania's economic growth**, requiring a more unified industry position



## PRACTICAL SUPPORT OVER FORMAL MEMBERSHIP

- Companies show **moderate engagement**, expecting more **tangible outcomes** such as funding opportunities, sales leads, and knowledge sharing
- Associations are perceived as valuable mainly when they deliver **concrete business or policy impact**



## THE ECOSYSTEM IS IN AN EARLY STAGE

- The collaborative innovation ecosystem is growing but **still in an early stage** of development
- Angel networks, regional development agencies, incubators and startup support initiatives are emerging
- Coordination and strategic alignment across actors remain limited



## HIGHLIGHTS

Collaborative ecosystems are expanding, but their practical impact remains limited due to fragmentation and insufficient coordination among ecosystem actors.

# Workforce diversity and sustainability

Diversity and sustainability remain important operational directions at companies: several companies offer **support for employees** after maternity leave; **environmental aspects** are generally taken into consideration during everyday activities (mostly for cost-cutting reasons); while the prevalence of specific green IT solutions as products sold remains low.



## WORKFORCE DIVERSITY

- In our survey sample the IT workforce is **predominantly Romanian (92%), male (62%) and young**, with the largest share of employees aged **25-34 (37%)**, followed by **35-44 (30%)**
- Employees are **highly educated**, with an average of **94%** in our sample **holding university degrees**, including **61% in computer science fields**
- **Flexible work arrangements** are the most common support measures, including **remote/hybrid work (58%)** and **flexible working hours (53%)**
- Women remain **underrepresented**, but companies increasingly recognize the importance of **supporting women's careers**, particularly during and after maternity leave
- **Formal reintegration policies are still limited**, as many companies handle maternity return **case-by-case or without structured programs**



## ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY & GREEN IT

- **Green IT adoption remains limited**, as sustainability is rarely integrated into core IT strategies and appears mainly through **CSR-type initiatives** rather than structured policies
- **Economic considerations dominate decisions**, with companies focusing primarily on **cost savings from energy-efficient equipment and infrastructure optimization**
- **Market incentives remain weak**, with only **7% of firms generating more than 80% of their revenue from green IT solutions**, and demand for eco-conscious solutions grows slowly
- **Structural barriers hinder implementation**, including high costs, infrastructure constraints, and **limited access to dedicated funding and incentives**



## HIGHLIGHTS

**Green IT adoption remains limited as sustainability is not yet strategically integrated and market incentives are weak, highlighting the need for stronger policy and financial support.**

**Sources:** Interviews (6) and Survey (122 IT companies)

# Future of the Romanian IT industry

The future of the Romanian IT industry is expected to be shaped by constant **adaptation to fiscal changes**, capitalizing on the growing adoption of **AI-based solutions**, and addressing **workforce challenges** – particularly talent acquisition – while strengthening university partnerships and investing in upskilling and reskilling.

## FUTURE OUTLOOK ON THE ROMANIAN IT INDUSTRY

### ADAPTING TO A CHANGING FISCAL ENVIRONMENT

- Companies must **adjust to recent fiscal and regulatory changes** affecting the IT sector
- The evolving tax landscape creates **short-term uncertainty**, requiring strategic adaptation by firms

### AI ADOPTION AS A STRATEGIC OPPORTUNITY

- The **growing adoption of AI-based solutions** represents a major opportunity for innovation and competitiveness
- Companies increasingly seek to **integrate AI technologies into products, services, and internal processes**

### WORKFORCE AND TALENT CHALLENGES

- **Talent acquisition remains difficult**, despite the recent slowdown in hiring that slightly eased labour market pressures
- Competitive advantage will depend on **finding skilled employees and investing in upskilling and reskilling existing staff**
- **Universities remain key partners** in supporting talent development and industry collaboration



### HIGHLIGHTS

Companies that successfully adapt to fiscal changes, leverage AI opportunities, and develop talent pipelines will strengthen their long-term competitiveness in the Romanian IT industry.





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